

Vivo T3 Ultra

Solid mid-ranger for everyone

After solidifying their position in the upper section of the mid-range, Vivo has moved to launch their T3 Ultra to capture the mid-range market. They retained the design of their more expensive phones and tried to make an overall value-for-money device which will give you the experience of owning a pricier phone without breaking the bank. I put the Vivo T3 Ultra through its paces, and here's what I found out –

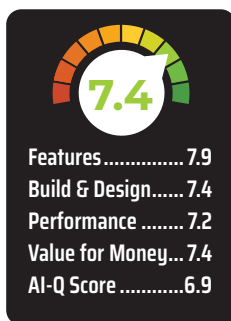
BUILD AND DESIGN

Vivo has adopted the – What ain't broke, don't fix it – mantra with the design of the Vivo T3 Ultra. They debuted the design that we see on the T3 Ultra on their more expensive line of V series phones with the Vivo V40 Series. If you are familiar with the in-hand feel of those devices, you will feel right at home with the T3 Ultra.

The in-hand feel of the device is amazing. With the tall aspect ratio, curved display, and rounded edges, it is fairly easy to hold and slide in and out of the pocket. In our testing, the phone came in at 196 grams, which is slightly on the higher side when compared to other offerings in the mid-range segment. However, you won't experience a lot of strain when using it for long periods of time.

The main differentiating factor between the V series and the T series when it comes to the build and design of the phones is evident when it comes to the material used in the phone. On the V40 series devices, we get Gorilla glass protection on the back, while the T3 Ultra gets a plastic back, which has a matte finish to it, and with or without the cover, it is quite a looker. The plastic backing means that there is no wireless charging either. A missing feature, but not a deal breaker given the charging capabilities of the phone with the included power adapter.

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More on that later. The side rails of the phone are made of polycarbonate material, which is also common in mid-range phones, and I honestly did not miss the metallic housing, which we see in more expensive devices during my time using the phone. We got the Forest

Green variant of the phone with 12 GB RAM and 256 GB storage for review. And the phone is quite a looker in the green colourway. It does not pick up a lot of fingerprints or scuffs when used without the cover.

All in all, the build and design of the Vivo T3 Ultra has a nice premium feel and finish to it, given its obvious resemblance to the more expensive V40 series. You get the worth of what you are paying for, and maybe a little extra when it comes to the overall feel and finish of the phone.

UI AND PERFORMANCE

In terms of the UI, the Vivo T3 Ultra is fairly decked out its share of modern smartphone essentials with a tiny sprin-

gling of AI features as well, which is nice to have. AI has been a buzzword floating around the tech world across categories, and Vivo did not miss out on boarding onto that train with the implementation of AI features on their latest phone. There are two prominent AI features that are limited to photography applications – AI erase, and AI photo enhance. They work well for what it's worth and earn the phone, the AI tag that brands are hunting for these days.

Vivo T3 Ultra comes out of the box with Funtouch OS 14, which is Vivo's take on Android 14. During the setup process, you are presented with the option to download some apps that are bundled. You can skip that, and when you are on the phone, it will be relatively bloatware-free. There are two folders titled Hot Games and Hot Apps, which are bundles of recommended software that Vivo is pushing on. However, you can simply remove those two folders to get rid of a lot of clutter from the screen. As for the apps, which are there on the phone from the get-go, they are the bare essentials, and I don't mind having these pre-loaded on the phone. However, giving a cleaner slate for the users to start with makes the experience better overall.

Unlike many other phones in this and lower price brackets, Vivo has decided to keep the user experience free of advertisements, so that is a plus. I am someone who daily drives an iPhone, so switching to the Android side of things took me a day to get used to. But once I was back in the groove, it was smooth sailing throughout. As I mentioned earlier, a cleaner slate to begin with would be nice. Overall, Funtouch OS is nice to use and fairly easy to get used to.

Now, we come to the main part, the performance. The phone comes with Dimensity 9200+ SoC and has up to 12GB RAM and 256GB of storage onboard.

In synthetic benchmarks, the Vivo T3 Ultra trumped the realme 13 Pro+ comprehensively in terms of the CPU and GPU performance. In storage benchmarks, the realme 13 Pro+ raced ahead or matched the T3 Ultra expect in the PCMark Sequential Write Speed test. When compared to the OnePlus Nord 4, the Vivo T3 Ultra again showed its stronghold in GPU perfor-